

# Antimicrobial chemotherapy

By

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## Intended Learning Outcomes (ILOs)

By the end of this lecture, the student will be able to:

1. **Define** antimicrobial drugs.
2. **Classify** antibiotics (source, action, spectrum).
3. **Differentiate** bacteriostatic vs bactericidal and narrow vs broad spectrum.
4. **Describe** main mechanisms of action.
5. **Relate** antimicrobial action to gene expression.

# Antimicrobial Drug

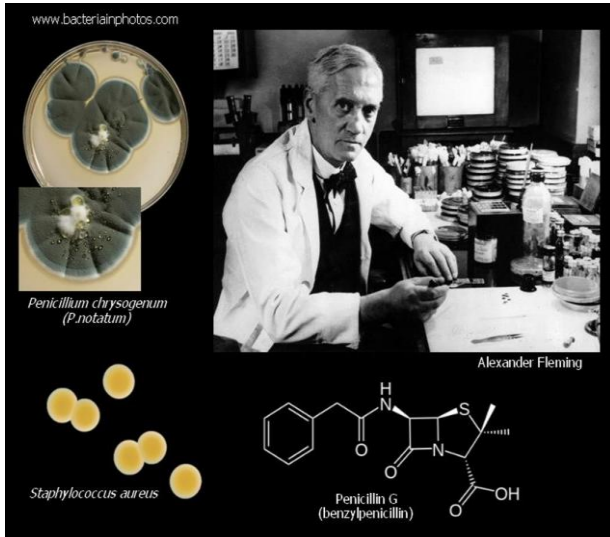
A substance, either **synthetic** or **naturally** occurring that **kills M.os** or **inhibits** the growth of microorganisms.



# Classifications of antibiotics

## 1) According to the source

### Naturally



### Synthetic

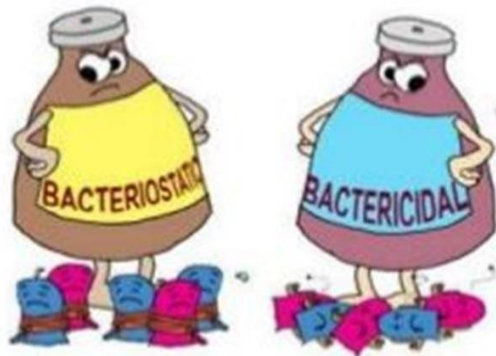


2)

Based on mode  
of Action

Bacteriostatic

Bactericidal



3)

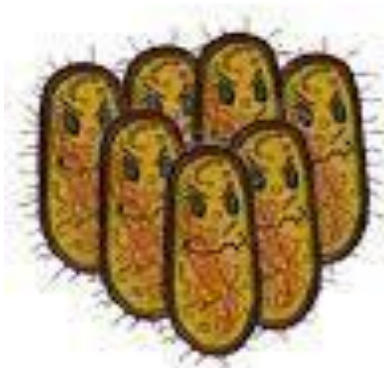
Based on their  
spectrum of  
action

Broad-spectrum

Narrow  
Spectrum



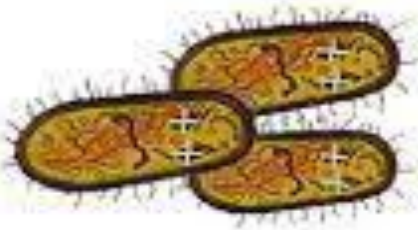
# Bacteriostatic vs Bactericidal



No antibiotics  
bacteria multiply



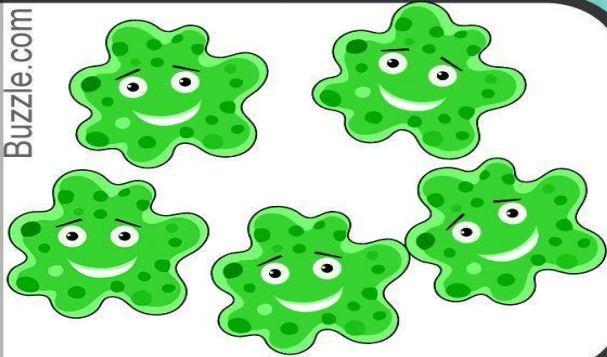
Bacteriostatic  
antibiotics  
prevent bacteria  
multiplying



Bactericidal  
antibiotics  
kill the bacteria

# Narrow spectrum vs Broad spectrum

Buzzle.com



**Narrow-spectrum**  
antibiotics act  
against a limited  
group of bacteria.

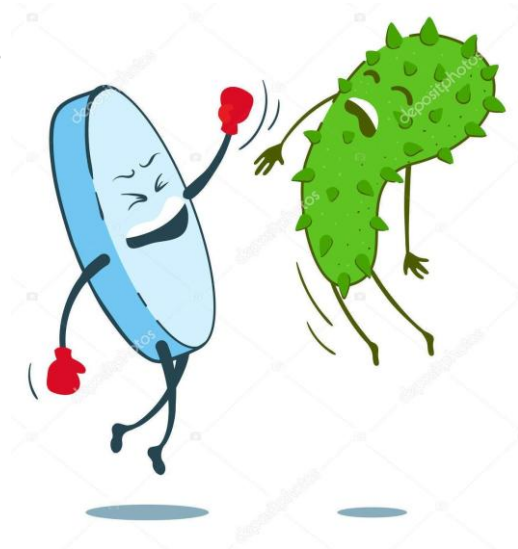


**Broad-spectrum**  
antibiotics act  
against a larger  
group of bacteria.



#### 4) According to mechanism of action

- a) Inhibition of **cell wall** synthesis (Bacterial peptidoglycan)
- b) Inhibition of **cell membrane** function.
- c) Inhibition of **nucleic acid** synthesis.
- d) Inhibition of **protein** synthesis.
- e) Inhibition of **metabolic pathway**.

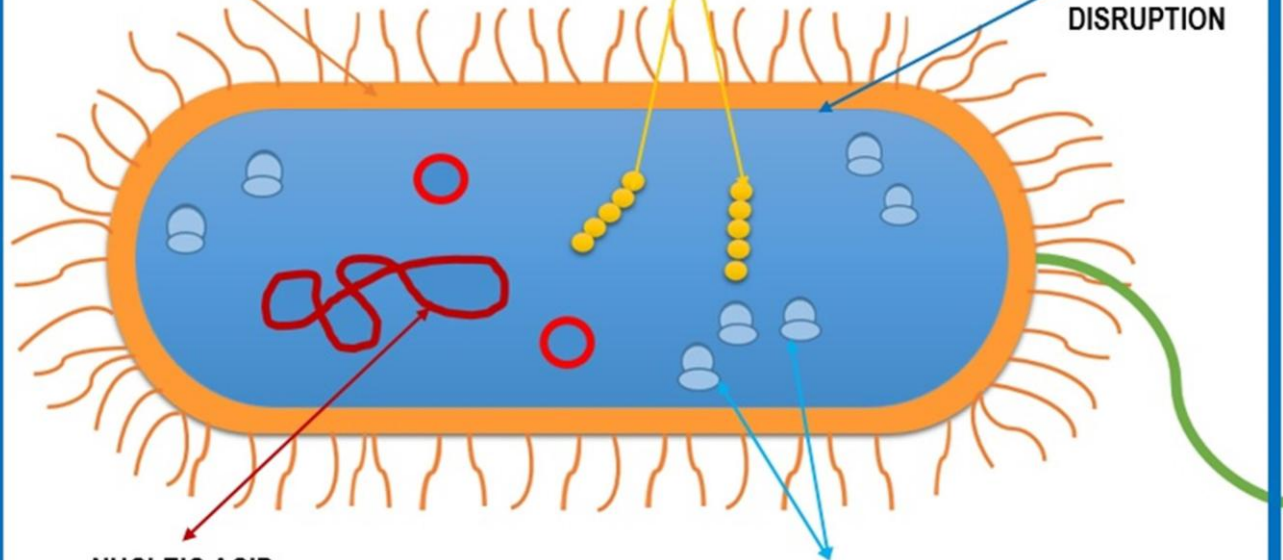




**CELL WALL  
BIOSYNTHESIS  
INHIBITION**

**FOLIC ACID INHIBITION**

**CELL  
MEMBRANE  
DISRUPTION**

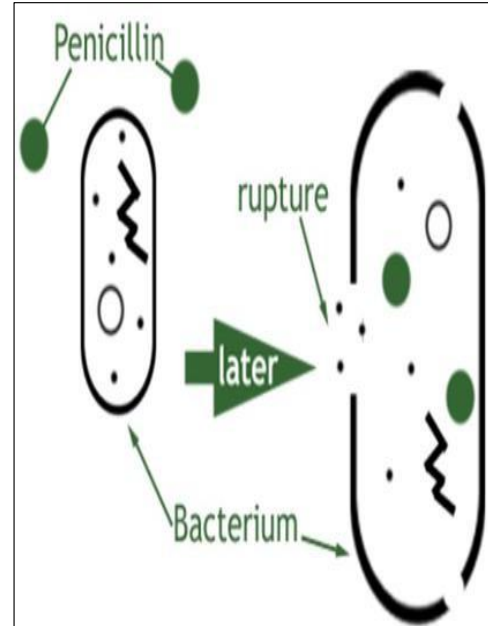


**NUCLEIC ACID  
SYNTHESIS INHIBITION**

**PROTEIN SYNTHESIS  
INHIBITION**

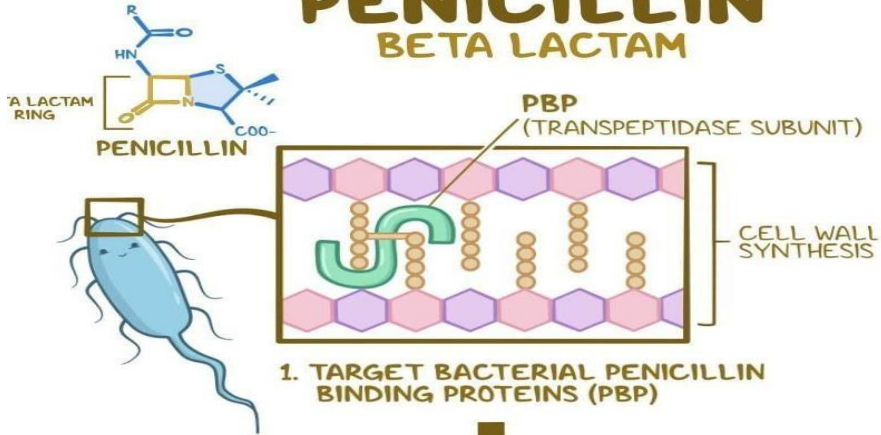
# 1- Inhibition of cell wall synthesis (Bacterial peptidoglycan):

- Binding of **B-lactams** to **cell wall receptors** (PBPs)  $\Rightarrow$  Inhibition of **transpeptidase**, the enzyme that catalyze the **final cross linking step** in the synthesis of peptidoglycan  $\Rightarrow$  **cell death and lysis**
- Act only on **growing cells** (metabolically active cells)
- E.g.  **$\beta$ -lactam antibiotics (Penicillins & Cephalosporins)**

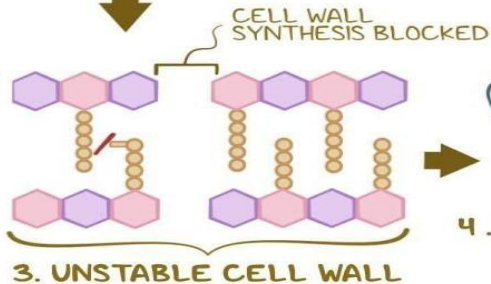


# PENICILLIN

## BETA LACTAM



2. INTERFERE with  
TRANSEPTIDATION



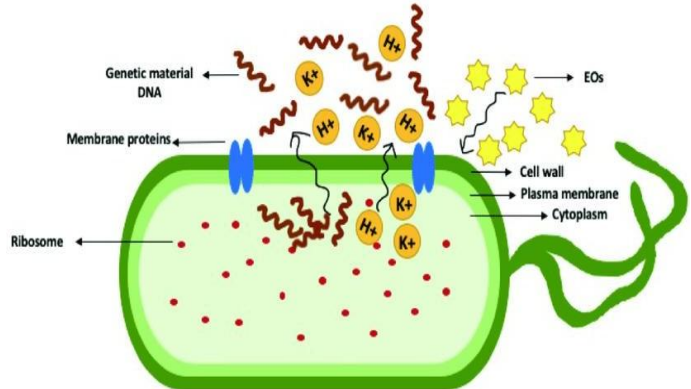
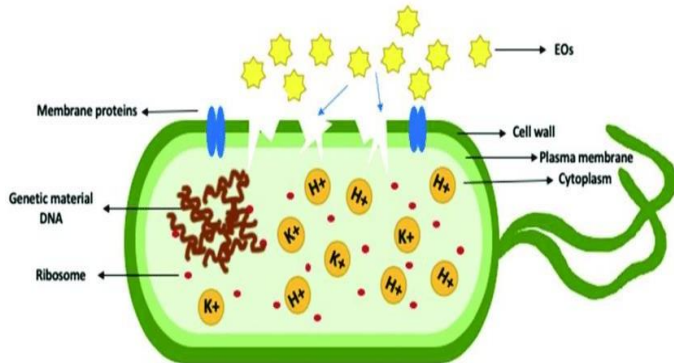
4. BACTERIAL  
DEATH



**Bactericidal**

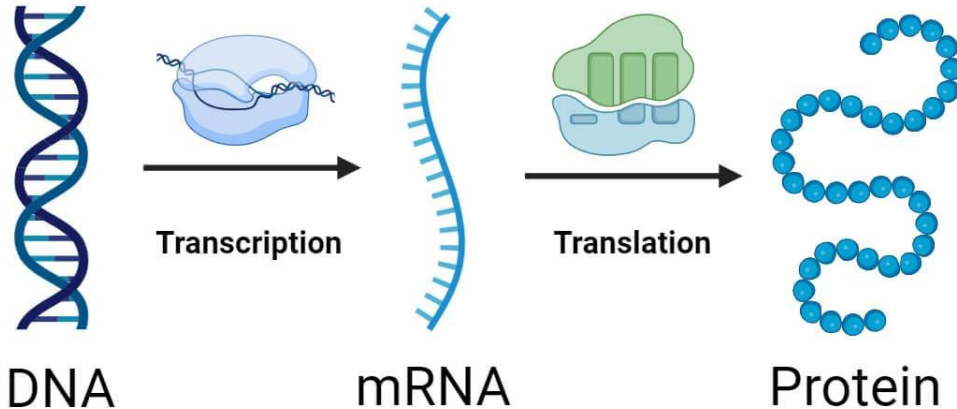
## 2. Inhibition of cell membrane function:

- Change the **permeability** of the cell membrane  $\Rightarrow$  **leakage of metabolic** substrates essential to life of the microorganism.
- **E.g. Polymyxin B, Amphotericin B**
- **Side effects: neurotoxic and nephrotoxic** “limited in use”



# Gene expression

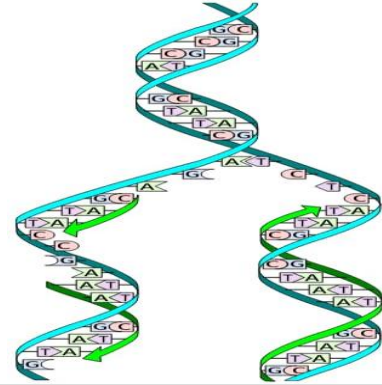
## Gene Expression



### 3. Inhibition of nucleic acid synthesis:

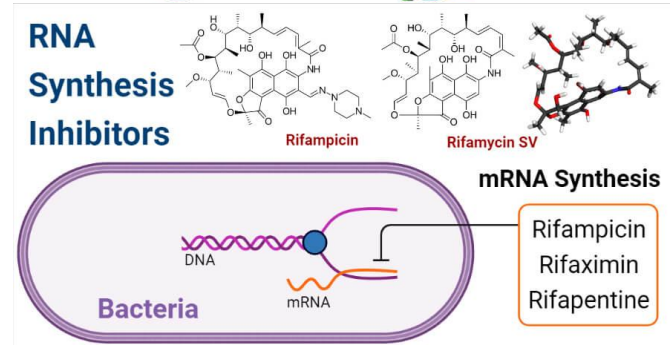
#### **A. Interference with DNA replication:**

- e.g. Quinolones (Ciprofloxacin)



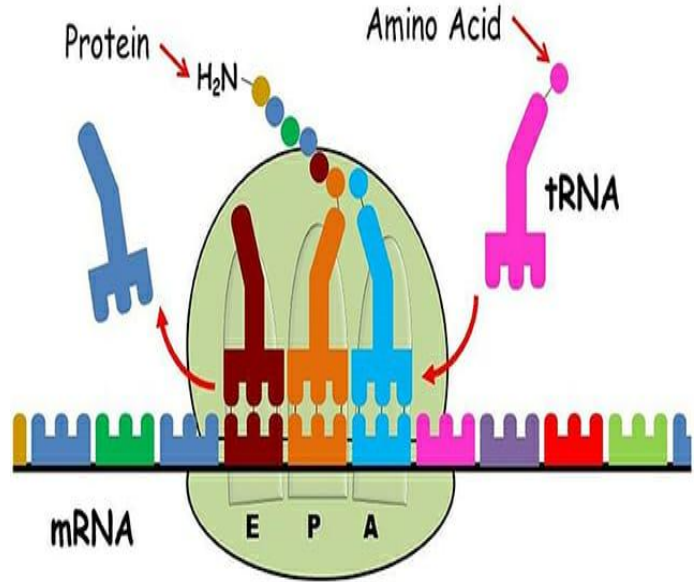
#### **B. Interference with RNA synthesis:**

- e.g. Rifampicin



## 4. Inhibition of protein synthesis:

- Interfere with **translation of proteins** by the **70S ribosome**
- The **difference** between ribosome of bacteria and mammalian cell (80S)  $\Rightarrow$  not dangerous on protein synthesis of mammalian ribosomes.
- **Examples:** Aminoglycosides, Tetracycline, Chloramphenicol





## Major classes of protein synthesis-inhibiting antibacterials

### Chloramphenicol, macrolides, and lincosamides

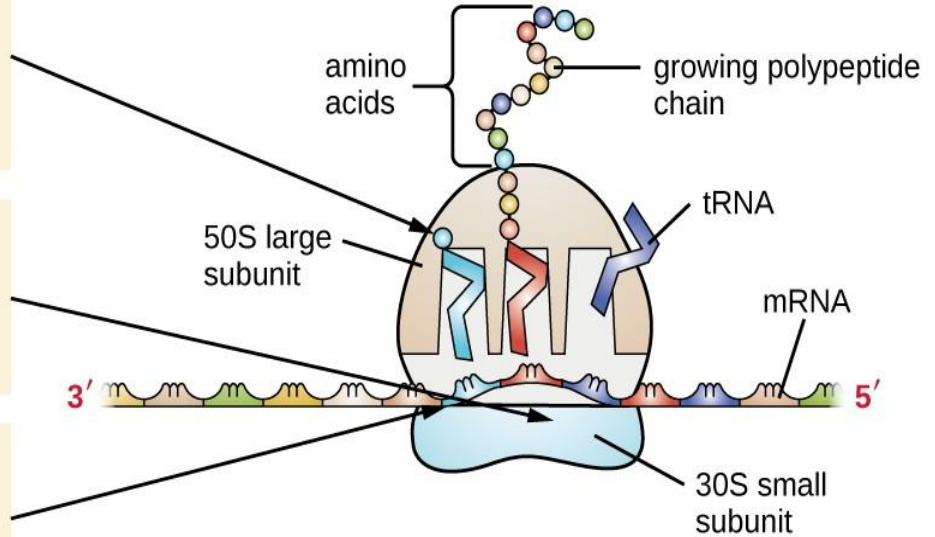
- Bind to the 50S ribosomal subunit
- Prevent peptide bond formation
- Stop protein synthesis

### Aminoglycosides

- Bind to the 30S ribosomal subunit
- Impair proofreading, resulting in production of faulty proteins

### Tetracyclines

- Bind to the 30S ribosomal subunit
- Block the binding of tRNAs, thereby inhibiting protein synthesis



30\$ Aminoglycoside  
Tetracycline

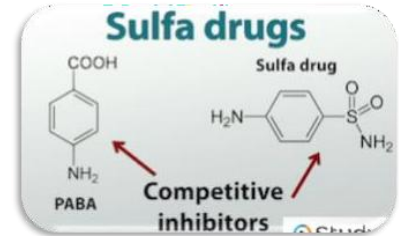
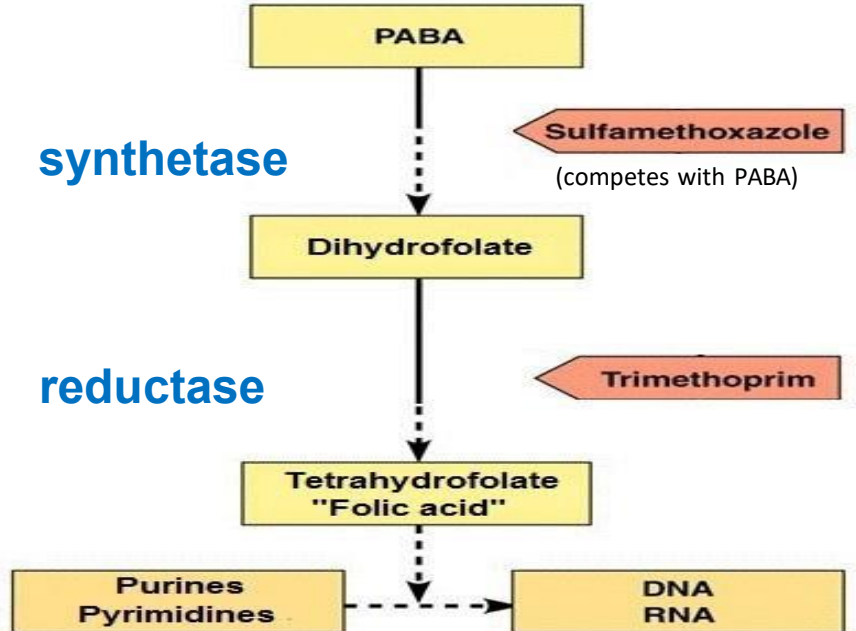


50\$ Cloramphenicol  
Erythromycin  
Lincomycin  
cLindamycin



Buy AT \$30, CELL at \$50!

## 5. Interference with essential metabolite synthesis: (Folic acid = precursor of purine and pyrimidine bases)



**Inhibition of cell wall synthesis:**  
Penicillins, cephalosporins,  
bacitracin, vancomycin

**Injury to plasma membrane:**  
Polymyxin B

**Inhibition of protein synthesis:**  
Chloramphenicol, erythromycin,  
tetracyclines, streptomycin



Protein



DNA

**Inhibition of nucleic acid replication and transcription:**  
Quinolones, rifampin



**Enzymatic activity, synthesis of essential metabolites**

**Inhibition of synthesis of essential metabolites:**  
Sulfanilamide, trimethoprim



### **Q1-Bactericidal antibiotics:**

- A) Stop bacterial growth**
- B) Kill bacteria**
- C) Stimulate immune system**
- D) Affect viruses only**

### **Q2-Broad-spectrum antibiotics:**

- A) Act on one type of bacteria**
- B) Act on a limited group**
- C) Act on a wide range of bacteria**
- D) Do not affect bacteria**

**Q3- Synthetic antibiotics differ from natural ones because they:**

- A) Are derived from plants**
- B) Are produced chemically in labs**
- C) Are inactive**
- D) Only affect fungi**

**Q4- In immunocompromised patients, bactericidal antibiotics are preferred because they:**

- A) Are cheaper**
- B) Kill bacteria directly**
- C) Have fewer side effects**
- D) Act slowly**

**Q5-The best strategy to reduce antibiotic resistance is:**

- A) Use antibiotics randomly**
- B) Use broad-spectrum always**
- C) Use antibiotics based on culture results**
- D) Increase dose for all patients**

**Q6-Overuse of broad-spectrum antibiotics may result in:**

- A) Faster recovery**
- B) Increased resistance**
- C) Reduced infection**
- D) No effect**



# Thank You

